

THE SKINNY

Fri, Oct 2

PITTSBURGH at VIRGINIA TECH

Pittsburgh (4-0) @ Virginia Tech (4-0)

Strength of Record -- Pittsburgh: #22 | Virginia Tech: #23

Offensive identity -- Pittsburgh: 46% pass / 54% run | Virginia Tech: 50% pass / 50% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.182	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.200
0.320	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.403

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
1.000	F+	0.620
0.550	FEI	0.180
2.7	Def Sacks/Game	4.0

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
32.7	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	33.3
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
13.5	FPI (77% real win rate)	8.9
0.640	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	0.720
44.7	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	46.1
0.120	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.140
86.4	QBR (73% real win rate)	85.5
1.210	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.340
0.3	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.2
-0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	-0.0
0.3	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.3
0.3	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.3
6.3	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.0
0.5	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.6
0.400	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	-0.020

THE READ

Up front, the stuff-rate and sack numbers are close to even -- this one likely comes down to who wins on the perimeter instead of at the line of scrimmage. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Virginia Tech -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Virginia Tech 26.6-22.2 over Pittsburgh (58% win probability), a projected margin of 4.4. On the ground, Pittsburgh's rush offense (171.3 yds/g) lines up against Virginia Tech's rush defense (112.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge Pittsburgh. Through the air, Pittsburgh's pass offense (271.7 yds/g) faces Virginia Tech's pass defense (219.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Pittsburgh. **Caution: without Virginia Tech's +12.0-point home-field edge, the underlying stat blend alone actually favors Pittsburgh.** Heads up: Virginia Tech does have the better Def Sacks/Game number in

this game, which runs against the model's own pick above (in our logged games, the model hits 93.8% when Def Sacks/Game agrees with its pick, 87.1% when it doesn't) -- be aware.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Virginia Tech's home-field rating (+12.0).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Fri, Oct 2

LIBERTY at DELAWARE

Liberty (3-1) @ Delaware (2-2)

Strength of Record -- Liberty: #70 | Delaware: #89

Offensive identity -- Liberty: 36% pass / 64% run | Delaware: 48% pass / 52% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.113	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.209
0.211	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.150

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
-0.020	F+	-0.910
-0.170	FEI	-0.660
2.3	Def Sacks/Game	4.0

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
32.7	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	17.0
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.2
-2.1	FPI (77% real win rate)	-8.9
0.180	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	-0.790
55.3	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	29.3
0.020	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.390
58.6	QBR (73% real win rate)	62.7
-0.280	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	-0.940
0.1	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.0
0.0	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.1
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
0.2	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	-0.1
6.4	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	4.5
0.6	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.2
-0.220	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	-0.290

THE READ

Up front, Liberty wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Liberty -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Liberty 26.3-22.4 over Delaware (57% win probability), a projected margin of 3.9. On the ground, Liberty's rush offense (188.7 yds/g) lines up against Delaware's rush defense (118.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Liberty. Through the air, Liberty's pass offense (233.3 yds/g) faces Delaware's pass defense (308.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge Liberty. Heads up: Delaware does have the better Def Sacks/Game number in this game, which runs against the model's own pick above (in our logged games, the model hits 93.8% when Def

Sacks/Game agrees with its pick, 87.1% when it doesn't) -- be aware.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, $n=95$, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Delaware's home-field rating (+12.0).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

PENN STATE at NORTHWESTERN

Penn State (3-1) @ Northwestern (2-1)

Strength of Record -- Penn State: #64 | Northwestern: #39

Offensive identity -- Penn State: 41% pass / 59% run | Northwestern: 40% pass / 60% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.136	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.190
0.229	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.142

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
1.360	F+	0.560
0.900	FEI	0.350
1.5	Def Sacks/Game	1.5

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
36.8	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	32.0
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
15.6	FPI (77% real win rate)	11.2
0.930	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	0.330
40.4	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	37.5
0.290	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.090
64.6	QBR (73% real win rate)	81.3
1.480	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.670
0.2	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.3
-0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.1
0.3	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
0.3	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.2
6.3	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.7
0.6	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.5
0.510	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.230

THE READ

Up front, Penn State wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Penn State -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Penn State 29.0-20.1 over Northwestern (66% win probability), a projected margin of 8.9. On the ground, Penn State's rush offense (183.5 yds/g) lines up against Northwestern's rush defense (225.5 yds/g allowed) -- edge Penn State. Through the air, Penn State's pass offense (243.8 yds/g) faces Northwestern's pass defense (184.5 yds/g allowed) -- edge Penn State.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Northwestern's home-field rating (-7.9).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

NOTRE DAME at NORTH CAROLINA

Notre Dame (4-0) @ North Carolina (2-1)

Strength of Record -- Notre Dame: #12 | North Carolina: #46

Offensive identity -- Notre Dame: 45% pass / 55% run | North Carolina: 46% pass / 54% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.153	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.125
0.223	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.122

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
2.240	F+	0.030
1.500	FEI	-0.120
3.3	Def Sacks/Game	3.0

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
42.3	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	17.5
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
27.8	FPI (77% real win rate)	5.3
1.920	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	-0.280
41.5	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	32.0
0.610	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.130
92.8	QBR (73% real win rate)	57.5
2.230	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.320
0.3	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.1
-0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	-0.0
0.3	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
0.5	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.1
6.6	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.1
0.7	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.4
0.830	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.000

THE READ

Up front, Notre Dame wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Notre Dame -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Notre Dame 36.3-7.3 over North Carolina (90% win probability), a projected margin of 29.0. On the ground, Notre Dame's rush offense (141.8 yds/g) lines up against North Carolina's rush defense (146.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Notre Dame. Through the air, Notre Dame's pass offense (275.0 yds/g) faces North Carolina's pass defense (195.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Notre Dame. Notre Dame also carries the turnover-margin edge (-0.5 vs +2.0).

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: North Carolina's home-field rating (-2.8).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

ALABAMA at MISSISSIPPI STATE

Alabama (4-0) @ Mississippi State (4-0)

Strength of Record -- Alabama: #3 | Mississippi State: #4

Offensive identity -- Alabama: 42% pass / 58% run | Mississippi State: 45% pass / 55% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.209	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.201
0.244	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.158

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
1.820	F+	1.060
1.210	FEI	0.610
2.8	Def Sacks/Game	2.3

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
48.0	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	43.0
0.2	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
24.6	FPI (77% real win rate)	14.3
1.860	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	1.530
45.8	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	47.8
0.610	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.470
90.4	QBR (73% real win rate)	89.4
1.500	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.480
0.3	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.4
-0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.0
0.3	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
0.3	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.2
6.9	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	7.3
0.6	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.7
0.550	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.200

THE READ

Up front, Alabama wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Alabama -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Alabama 40.2-25.9 over Mississippi State (74% win probability), a projected margin of 14.3. On the ground, Mississippi State's rush offense (217.8 yds/g) lines up against Alabama's rush defense (93.8 yds/g allowed) -- edge Mississippi State. Through the air, Mississippi State's pass offense (315.5 yds/g) faces Alabama's pass defense (221.5 yds/g allowed) -- edge Mississippi State. Alabama also carries the turnover-margin edge (-0.3 vs +1.3).

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Mississippi State's home-field rating (-7.3).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

UCF at HOUSTON

UCF (3-1) @ Houston (3-1)

Strength of Record -- UCF: #40 | Houston: #44

Offensive identity -- UCF: 42% pass / 58% run | Houston: 43% pass / 57% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.172	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.099
0.241	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.214

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.470	F+	0.650
0.170	FEI	0.240
2.3	Def Sacks/Game	2.3

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
24.0	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	33.7
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
6.5	FPI (77% real win rate)	11.5
-0.070	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	1.260
28.6	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	64.9
-0.130	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.350
42.4	QBR (73% real win rate)	89.5
0.960	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.000
0.1	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.4
-0.0	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.1
0.3	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
0.0	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.2
5.1	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	6.7
0.4	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.6
0.280	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	-0.060

THE READ

Up front, Houston wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Houston -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Houston 35.2-15.4 over UCF (81% win probability), a projected margin of 19.8. On the ground, Houston's rush offense (201.7 yds/g) lines up against UCF's rush defense (113.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Houston. Through the air, Houston's pass offense (275.7 yds/g) faces UCF's pass defense (268.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Houston. UCF also carries the turnover-margin edge (+0.0 vs +1.3).

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, $n=95$, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Houston's home-field rating (+11.6).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

BOSTON COLLEGE at SMU

Boston College (2-2) @ SMU (3-1)

Strength of Record -- Boston College: #84 | SMU: #37

Offensive identity -- Boston College: 45% pass / 55% run | SMU: 49% pass / 51% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.252	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.164
0.195	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.213

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
-0.340	F+	0.740
-0.230	FEI	0.310
2.0	Def Sacks/Game	3.3

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
19.0	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	30.7
0.2	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
-4.8	FPI (77% real win rate)	9.1
-0.710	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	1.000
26.3	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	52.5
-0.290	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.200
51.2	QBR (73% real win rate)	87.3
0.150	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.510
-0.0	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.3
0.0	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.0
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
-0.1	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.1
5.2	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	7.2
0.3	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.5
0.100	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.170

THE READ

Up front, SMU wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors SMU -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors SMU 34.3-18.1 over Boston College (77% win probability), a projected margin of 16.2. On the ground, SMU's rush offense (180.0 yds/g) lines up against Boston College's rush defense (210.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge SMU. Through the air, SMU's pass offense (372.0 yds/g) faces Boston College's pass defense (154.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge SMU. Boston College also carries the turnover-margin edge (-2.3 vs +0.0).

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: SMU's home-field rating (-2.3).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

WEST VIRGINIA at IOWA STATE

West Virginia (3-1) @ Iowa State (2-2)

Strength of Record -- West Virginia: #45 | Iowa State: #91

Offensive identity -- West Virginia: 23% pass / 77% run | Iowa State: 41% pass / 59% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.135	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.190
0.203	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.198

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.030	F+	0.580
-0.040	FEI	0.560
2.7	Def Sacks/Game	0.3

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
31.0	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	28.3
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.2
2.5	FPI (77% real win rate)	4.0
0.430	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	0.180
49.0	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	29.7
0.060	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.160
90.7	QBR (73% real win rate)	70.0
-0.350	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.750
0.2	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.1
0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	-0.0
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
-0.0	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.0
5.6	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.6
0.4	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.4
-0.060	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.290

THE READ

Up front, West Virginia wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors West Virginia -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors West Virginia 28.0-26.0 over Iowa State (54% win probability), a projected margin of 2.0. On the ground, West Virginia's rush offense (287.7 yds/g) lines up against Iowa State's rush defense (129.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge West Virginia. Through the air, Iowa State's pass offense (154.7 yds/g) faces West Virginia's pass defense (319.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge Iowa State. **Caution: without Iowa State's -3.4-point home-field edge, the underlying stat blend alone actually favors Iowa State. Caution: both F+ and**

FEI favor Iowa State, the opposite of the model's own pick above.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Iowa State's home-field rating (-3.4).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

STANFORD at WAKE FOREST

Stanford (2-2) @ Wake Forest (3-1)

Strength of Record -- Stanford: #61 | Wake Forest: #17

Offensive identity -- Stanford: 55% pass / 45% run | Wake Forest: 49% pass / 51% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.212	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.146
0.145	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.213

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
-0.600	F+	0.390
-0.380	FEI	0.310
1.0	Def Sacks/Game	2.5

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
21.0	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	31.5
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
-5.7	FPI (77% real win rate)	6.0
-0.460	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	0.460
33.9	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	37.5
-0.180	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.140
67.0	QBR (73% real win rate)	82.0
-0.660	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.320
0.1	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.3
0.3	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.2
0.5	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.5
-0.1	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.1
5.4	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	6.4
0.4	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.6
-0.200	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.210

THE READ

Up front, Wake Forest wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Wake Forest -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Wake Forest 35.9-21.1 over Stanford (75% win probability), a projected margin of 14.8. On the ground, Wake Forest's rush offense (147.0 yds/g) lines up against Stanford's rush defense (149.5 yds/g allowed) -- edge Wake Forest. Through the air, Wake Forest's pass offense (279.5 yds/g) faces Stanford's pass defense (294.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge Wake Forest. Stanford also carries the turnover-margin edge (+0.0 vs +1.3).

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, $n=95$, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Wake Forest's home-field rating (-0.2).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

SYRACUSE at UCONN

Syracuse (1-2) @ UConn (2-2)

Strength of Record -- Syracuse: #107 | UConn: #102

Offensive identity -- Syracuse: 53% pass / 47% run | UConn: 42% pass / 58% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.220	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.168
0.233	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.212

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
-0.260	F+	--
-0.280	FEI	--
1.5	Def Sacks/Game	1.0

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
15.5	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	27.7
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
0.6	FPI (77% real win rate)	-7.2
-0.570	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	--
38.7	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	43.6
-0.270	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	--
44.7	QBR (73% real win rate)	80.7
0.210	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	--
0.0	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.2
-0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.0
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
0.0	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	--
4.8	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.3
0.4	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	--
0.070	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	--

THE READ

Up front, Syracuse wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors UConn -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Syracuse 28.4-18.9 over UConn (67% win probability), a projected margin of 9.5. On the ground, UConn's rush offense (147.3 yds/g) lines up against Syracuse's rush defense (156.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge UConn. Through the air, Syracuse's pass offense (265.5 yds/g) faces UConn's pass defense (324.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge Syracuse. UConn also carries the turnover-margin edge (+0.0 vs -2.0). Heads up: Syracuse does have the better Def Sacks/Game number in this game, which runs against the model's own pick

above (in our logged games, the model hits 93.8% when Def Sacks/Game agrees with its pick, 87.1% when it doesn't) -- be aware.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, $n=95$, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: UConn's home-field rating (-6.7).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

MICHIGAN at MINNESOTA

Michigan (3-1) @ Minnesota (3-1)

Strength of Record -- Michigan: #36 | Minnesota: #43

Offensive identity -- Michigan: 39% pass / 61% run | Minnesota: 57% pass / 43% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.127	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.241
0.223	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.270

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
1.080	F+	0.400
0.680	FEI	0.180
3.0	Def Sacks/Game	3.3

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
25.3	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	27.0
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
13.3	FPI (77% real win rate)	1.8
0.650	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	0.040
42.9	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	31.7
0.280	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.090
63.2	QBR (73% real win rate)	72.3
1.430	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.610
0.2	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.1
-0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.0
0.3	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
0.1	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.1
5.6	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.3
0.4	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.4
0.400	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.190

THE READ

Up front, Minnesota wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Minnesota -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Michigan 29.4-15.7 over Minnesota (73% win probability), a projected margin of 13.7. On the ground, Michigan's rush offense (149.0 yds/g) lines up against Minnesota's rush defense (113.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge Michigan. Through the air, Michigan's pass offense (200.8 yds/g) faces Minnesota's pass defense (213.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Michigan. Minnesota also carries the turnover-margin edge (+1.0 vs -0.8). Heads up: Minnesota does have the better Def Sacks/Game number in this game, which runs against

the model's own pick above (in our logged games, the model hits 93.8% when Def Sacks/Game agrees with its pick, 87.1% when it doesn't) -- be aware.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Minnesota's home-field rating (-3.7).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

NAVY at AIR FORCE

Navy (1-2) @ Air Force (2-1)

Strength of Record -- Navy: #122 | Air Force: #81

Offensive identity -- Navy: 27% pass / 73% run | Air Force: 19% pass / 81% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.099	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.068
0.207	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.216

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
-0.320	F+	-0.390
-0.250	FEI	-0.350
3.5	Def Sacks/Game	2.0

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
25.0	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	34.0
0.2	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
-7.1	FPI (77% real win rate)	-5.3
-0.100	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	0.280
38.5	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	43.8
-0.100	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.150
78.1	QBR (73% real win rate)	74.6
-0.500	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	-0.910
0.2	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.3
0.2	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.0
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.3
-0.2	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	-0.0
5.4	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.6
0.4	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.5
-0.130	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	-0.390

THE READ

Up front, Air Force wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Air Force -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Air Force 38.9-23.9 over Navy (75% win probability), a projected margin of 15.0. On the ground, Navy's rush offense (247.5 yds/g) lines up against Air Force's rush defense (166.5 yds/g allowed) -- edge Navy. Through the air, Air Force's pass offense (135.5 yds/g) faces Navy's pass defense (280.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Air Force. Air Force also carries the turnover-margin edge (-0.5 vs -1.5).

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Air Force's home-field rating (+7.6).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

MICHIGAN STATE at WISCONSIN

Michigan State (2-2) @ Wisconsin (3-1)

Strength of Record -- Michigan State: #55 | Wisconsin: #7

Offensive identity -- Michigan State: 41% pass / 59% run | Wisconsin: 53% pass / 47% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.204	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.154
0.260	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.105

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.100	F+	0.670
0.100	FEI	0.500
1.8	Def Sacks/Game	1.7

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
22.0	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	30.3
0.2	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.2
3.6	FPI (77% real win rate)	7.4
-0.010	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	-0.120
44.2	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	42.5
-0.010	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.070
70.1	QBR (73% real win rate)	50.6
0.030	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	1.390
0.0	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.1
0.2	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	-0.1
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.3
0.1	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.1
4.7	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.8
0.5	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.4
-0.010	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.550

THE READ

Up front, the stuff-rate and sack numbers are close to even -- this one likely comes down to who wins on the perimeter instead of at the line of scrimmage. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Wisconsin -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Wisconsin 27.9-20.8 over Michigan State (63% win probability), a projected margin of 7.1. On the ground, Wisconsin's rush offense (101.3 yds/g) lines up against Michigan State's rush defense (124.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Wisconsin. Through the air, Wisconsin's pass offense (271.3 yds/g) faces Michigan State's pass defense (190.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Wisconsin. Heads up: Michigan State does have the better Def Sacks/Game number in this game, which runs against the model's own pick above (in our logged games, the model hits 93.8% when Def Sacks/Game agrees with

its pick, 87.1% when it doesn't) -- be aware.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Wisconsin's home-field rating (+1.9).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

VANDERBILT at GEORGIA

Vanderbilt (3-1) @ Georgia (4-0)

Strength of Record -- Vanderbilt: #47 | Georgia: #8

Offensive identity -- Vanderbilt: 49% pass / 51% run | Georgia: 41% pass / 59% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.150	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.119
0.200	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.216

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.550	F+	2.360
0.330	FEI	1.550
2.7	Def Sacks/Game	2.7

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
28.3	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	52.0
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
5.5	FPI (77% real win rate)	28.3
0.620	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	2.050
31.8	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	48.6
0.220	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.650
70.1	QBR (73% real win rate)	92.3
0.340	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	2.230
0.1	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.4
-0.0	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	-0.1
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.3
0.0	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.5
5.1	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	7.0
0.4	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.6
0.080	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.790

THE READ

Up front, Georgia wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Georgia -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Georgia 47.8-13.7 over Vanderbilt (93% win probability), a projected margin of 34.1. On the ground, Georgia's rush offense (205.7 yds/g) lines up against Vanderbilt's rush defense (134.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge Georgia. Through the air, Vanderbilt's pass offense (238.3 yds/g) faces Georgia's pass defense (209.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge Vanderbilt. Georgia also carries the turnover-margin edge (+1.7 vs +0.0).

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Georgia's home-field rating (+5.1).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

TOLEDO at BALL STATE

Toledo (3-1) @ Ball State (1-3)

Strength of Record -- Toledo: #67 | Ball State: #121

Offensive identity -- Toledo: 50% pass / 50% run | Ball State: 50% pass / 50% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.170	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.214
0.207	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.188

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.060	F+	-1.830
0.050	FEI	-1.150
2.7	Def Sacks/Game	1.0

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
36.7	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	10.3
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.2
0.9	FPI (77% real win rate)	-23.3
0.080	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	-1.700
46.0	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	24.3
0.000	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.590
82.8	QBR (73% real win rate)	47.9
0.100	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	-1.620
0.3	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.0
-0.0	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.3
0.3	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.5
0.0	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	-0.4
6.9	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	3.6
0.5	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.2
0.080	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	-0.490

THE READ

Up front, Toledo wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Toledo -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Toledo 42.3-19.0 over Ball State (85% win probability), a projected margin of 23.3. On the ground, Toledo's rush offense (131.3 yds/g) lines up against Ball State's rush defense (204.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge Toledo. Through the air, Toledo's pass offense (303.0 yds/g) faces Ball State's pass defense (290.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge Toledo.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, $n=95$, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Ball State's home-field rating (+12.0).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

OHIO STATE at IOWA

Ohio State (3-1) @ Iowa (4-0)

Strength of Record -- Ohio State: #30 | Iowa: #5

Offensive identity -- Ohio State: 49% pass / 51% run | Iowa: 54% pass / 46% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.168	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.132
0.194	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.193

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
2.160	F+	1.160
1.360	FEI	0.750
1.8	Def Sacks/Game	2.3

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
45.0	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	25.3
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
27.8	FPI (77% real win rate)	12.8
2.110	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	0.130
44.4	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	39.5
0.690	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.080
95.0	QBR (73% real win rate)	75.1
1.980	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	1.820
0.4	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.2
-0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	-0.1
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.3
0.4	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.2
7.6	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.4
0.6	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.5
0.670	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.650

THE READ

Up front, Iowa wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Ohio State -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Ohio State 33.1-13.6 over Iowa (81% win probability), a projected margin of 19.5. On the ground, Iowa's rush offense (146.7 yds/g) lines up against Ohio State's rush defense (114.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Iowa. Through the air, Ohio State's pass offense (365.3 yds/g) faces Iowa's pass defense (168.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge Ohio State. **Caution: both F+ and FEI favor Ohio State, the opposite of the model's own pick above.**

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, $n=95$, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Iowa's home-field rating (-0.4).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

FLORIDA at MISSOURI

Florida (4-0) @ Missouri (3-1)

Strength of Record -- Florida: #2 | Missouri: #42

Offensive identity -- Florida: 33% pass / 67% run | Missouri: 46% pass / 54% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.133	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.172
0.109	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.244

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
1.290	F+	0.900
0.750	FEI	0.480
3.3	Def Sacks/Game	3.7

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
54.0	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	29.7
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.2
19.2	FPI (77% real win rate)	9.6
1.580	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	0.470
51.4	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	37.2
0.450	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.040
89.9	QBR (73% real win rate)	81.7
0.650	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	1.240
0.4	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.2
-0.0	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	-0.0
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
0.4	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.1
7.3	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.6
0.8	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.5
0.200	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.410

THE READ

Up front, Missouri wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Florida -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Florida 47.9-20.1 over Missouri (89% win probability), a projected margin of 27.8. On the ground, Florida's rush offense (275.3 yds/g) lines up against Missouri's rush defense (104.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Florida. Through the air, Florida's pass offense (263.7 yds/g) faces Missouri's pass defense (254.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge Florida. Heads up: Missouri does have the better Def Sacks/Game number in this game, which runs against the model's own pick above (in our logged games, the model hits 93.8% when Def

Sacks/Game agrees with its pick, 87.1% when it doesn't) -- be aware.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, $n=95$, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Missouri's home-field rating (-8.0).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

AUBURN at TENNESSEE

Auburn (3-1) @ Tennessee (3-1)

Strength of Record -- Auburn: #27 | Tennessee: #35

Offensive identity -- Auburn: 46% pass / 54% run | Tennessee: 38% pass / 62% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.152	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.138
0.185	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.191

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.840	F+	1.360
0.520	FEI	0.870
2.8	Def Sacks/Game	4.0

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
30.0	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	34.7
0.2	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
13.0	FPI (77% real win rate)	18.2
0.320	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	1.390
49.2	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	40.0
0.060	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.420
73.3	QBR (73% real win rate)	71.7
1.180	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	1.080
0.1	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.2
-0.0	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	-0.1
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
0.0	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.2
5.5	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.0
0.5	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.5
0.380	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.400

THE READ

Up front, Tennessee wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Tennessee -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Tennessee 28.1-23.5 over Auburn (58% win probability), a projected margin of 4.6. On the ground, Tennessee's rush offense (212.3 yds/g) lines up against Auburn's rush defense (127.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Tennessee. Through the air, Auburn's pass offense (235.0 yds/g) faces Tennessee's pass defense (203.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge Auburn. Tennessee also carries the turnover-margin edge (+1.3 vs +0.0).

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Tennessee's home-field rating (+0.3).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

CALIFORNIA at UNLV

California (2-2) @ UNLV (2-2)

Strength of Record -- California: #74 | UNLV: #98

Offensive identity -- California: 54% pass / 46% run | UNLV: 43% pass / 57% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.205	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.130
0.145	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.133

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
-0.250	F+	-0.300
-0.180	FEI	-0.290
2.3	Def Sacks/Game	2.5

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
18.3	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	21.5
0.2	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.2
-2.1	FPI (77% real win rate)	-2.9
-0.400	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	-0.280
37.0	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	38.3
-0.190	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.230
63.9	QBR (73% real win rate)	74.7
-0.030	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	-0.290
0.0	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.1
0.0	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.1
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
-0.2	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	-0.1
4.2	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.7
0.3	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.3
0.010	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	-0.050

THE READ

Up front, the stuff-rate and sack numbers are close to even -- this one likely comes down to who wins on the perimeter instead of at the line of scrimmage. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors UNLV -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors UNLV 23.6-21.7 over California (54% win probability), a projected margin of 2.0. On the ground, UNLV's rush offense (179.5 yds/g) lines up against California's rush defense (216.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge UNLV. Through the air, UNLV's pass offense (225.0 yds/g) faces California's pass defense (203.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge UNLV. **Caution: both F+ and FEI favor California, the opposite of the model's own pick above.**

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, $n=95$, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: UNLV's home-field rating (-1.0).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

LOUISVILLE at NORTH CAROLINA STATE

Louisville (2-2) @ North Carolina State (2-2)

Strength of Record -- Louisville: #68 | North Carolina State: #79

Offensive identity -- Louisville: 44% pass / 56% run | North Carolina State: 47% pass / 53% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.194	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.149
0.121	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.190

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.780	F+	0.200
0.510	FEI	0.070
1.7	Def Sacks/Game	0.7

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
35.3	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	26.7
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.2
10.8	FPI (77% real win rate)	2.7
0.950	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	0.500
41.5	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	47.8
0.180	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.050
82.4	QBR (73% real win rate)	74.1
0.450	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	-0.070
0.3	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.2
0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.1
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
0.0	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	-0.1
6.3	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.0
0.5	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.4
0.300	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.070

THE READ

Up front, North Carolina State wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Louisville -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors North Carolina State 34.5-30.1 over Louisville (58% win probability), a projected margin of 4.4. On the ground, North Carolina State's rush offense (149.3 yds/g) lines up against Louisville's rush defense (195.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge North Carolina State. Through the air, Louisville's pass offense (269.3 yds/g) faces North Carolina State's pass defense (249.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge Louisville. Louisville also carries the turnover-margin edge (-0.7 vs +1.7). **Caution: without North Carolina State's +12.0-point**

home-field edge, the underlying stat blend alone actually favors Louisville. Heads up: Louisville does have the better Def Sacks/Game number in this game, which runs against the model's own pick above (in our logged games, the model hits 93.8% when Def Sacks/Game agrees with its pick, 87.1% when it doesn't) -- be aware. **Caution: both F+ and FEI favor Louisville, the opposite of the model's own pick above.**

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: North Carolina State's home-field rating (+12.0).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

VIRGINIA at FLORIDA STATE

Virginia (3-1) @ Florida State (2-2)

Strength of Record -- Virginia: #66 | Florida State: #87

Offensive identity -- Virginia: 39% pass / 61% run | Florida State: 40% pass / 60% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.133	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.152
0.188	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.180

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.810	F+	0.540
0.330	FEI	0.390
2.0	Def Sacks/Game	1.3

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
34.3	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	31.3
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
11.8	FPI (77% real win rate)	6.6
0.610	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	0.970
35.6	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	40.9
0.090	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.350
91.7	QBR (73% real win rate)	80.1
0.990	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	-0.090
0.3	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.2
-0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.2
0.3	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
0.3	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	-0.1
5.7	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.9
0.5	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.5
0.290	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	-0.010

THE READ

Up front, Virginia wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Virginia -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Virginia 36.7-19.9 over Florida State (78% win probability), a projected margin of 16.9. On the ground, Virginia's rush offense (178.0 yds/g) lines up against Florida State's rush defense (149.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge Virginia. Through the air, Virginia's pass offense (263.0 yds/g) faces Florida State's pass defense (340.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge Virginia. Virginia also carries the turnover-margin edge (+0.0 vs +1.0).

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Florida State's home-field rating (-8.0).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

MEMPHIS at CHARLOTTE

Memphis (3-1) @ Charlotte (0-4)

Strength of Record -- Memphis: #48 | Charlotte: #135

Offensive identity -- Memphis: 38% pass / 62% run | Charlotte: 56% pass / 44% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.148	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.279
0.127	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.247

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.090	F+	-1.800
-0.010	FEI	-1.000
3.0	Def Sacks/Game	1.3

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
29.7	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	12.3
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.2
0.0	FPI (77% real win rate)	-18.6
0.670	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	-1.910
32.1	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	13.9
0.140	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.710
90.8	QBR (73% real win rate)	40.6
-0.540	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	-1.310
0.3	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	-0.1
0.2	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.2
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.5
0.1	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	-0.3
8.2	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	4.2
0.5	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.2
-0.140	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	-0.210

THE READ

Up front, the stuff-rate and sack numbers are close to even -- this one likely comes down to who wins on the perimeter instead of at the line of scrimmage. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Memphis -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Memphis 46.9-4.8 over Charlotte (96% win probability), a projected margin of 42.1. On the ground, Memphis's rush offense (221.7 yds/g) lines up against Charlotte's rush defense (116.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge Memphis. Through the air, Memphis's pass offense (265.0 yds/g) faces Charlotte's pass defense (265.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge Memphis. Memphis also carries the turnover-margin edge (-1.0 vs +0.0).

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Charlotte's home-field rating (-8.0).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

WYOMING at NORTH DAKOTA STATE

Wyoming (2-2) @ North Dakota State (4-0)

Strength of Record -- Wyoming: #111 | North Dakota State: #34

Offensive identity -- Wyoming: 42% pass / 58% run | North Dakota State: 38% pass / 62% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.140	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.191
0.145	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.180

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
-1.010	F+	-0.110
-0.700	FEI	-0.530
1.0	Def Sacks/Game	1.3

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
16.7	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	34.0
0.2	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
-16.1	FPI (77% real win rate)	-0.4
-1.440	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	-0.340
36.4	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	39.5
-0.520	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.390
39.4	QBR (73% real win rate)	83.6
-0.480	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.010
0.2	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.2
0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	-0.2
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
-0.1	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.3
5.6	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.9
0.4	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.6
-0.220	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	-0.220

THE READ

Up front, North Dakota State wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors North Dakota State -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors North Dakota State 37.8-7.2 over Wyoming (91% win probability), a projected margin of 30.6. On the ground, North Dakota State's rush offense (169.0 yds/g) lines up against Wyoming's rush defense (198.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge North Dakota State. Through the air, North Dakota State's pass offense (200.7 yds/g) faces Wyoming's pass defense (166.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge North Dakota State. North Dakota State also carries the turnover-margin edge (+1.0 vs -2.0).

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: North Dakota State's home-field rating (+9.5).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

AKRON at CENTRAL MICHIGAN

Akron (1-3) @ Central Michigan (2-2)

Strength of Record -- Akron: #127 | Central Michigan: #83

Offensive identity -- Akron: 52% pass / 48% run | Central Michigan: 30% pass / 70% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.130	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.129
0.188	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.135

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
-1.790	F+	-1.360
-1.200	FEI	-0.860
0.3	Def Sacks/Game	1.3

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
11.0	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	11.3
0.2	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.2
-20.1	FPI (77% real win rate)	-16.4
-1.650	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	-1.460
35.0	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	34.2
-0.610	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.420
73.9	QBR (73% real win rate)	68.9
-1.460	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	-0.960
0.0	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.0
0.2	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.2
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.5
-0.5	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	-0.4
4.3	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	3.9
0.1	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.2
-0.430	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	-0.370

THE READ

Up front, Central Michigan wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Central Michigan -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Central Michigan 27.4-19.9 over Akron (63% win probability), a projected margin of 7.4. On the ground, Central Michigan's rush offense (159.7 yds/g) lines up against Akron's rush defense (199.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Central Michigan. Through the air, Akron's pass offense (174.3 yds/g) faces Central Michigan's pass defense (236.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge Akron. **Caution: without Central Michigan's +8.1-point home-field edge, the underlying stat blend alone actually favors Akron.**

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Central Michigan's home-field rating (+8.1).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

OHIO at KENT STATE

Ohio (2-2) @ Kent State (2-2)

Strength of Record -- Ohio: #96 | Kent State: #85

Offensive identity -- Ohio: 44% pass / 56% run | Kent State: 40% pass / 60% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.101	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.223
0.209	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.156

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
-0.700	F+	-1.650
-0.400	FEI	-1.050
0.7	Def Sacks/Game	1.3

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
28.7	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	9.7
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.2
-10.0	FPI (77% real win rate)	-21.6
-0.500	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	-1.480
51.2	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	34.1
-0.150	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.470
79.1	QBR (73% real win rate)	80.1
-0.880	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	-1.580
0.2	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	-0.0
0.3	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.2
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.5
-0.1	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	-0.4
4.8	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	3.9
0.5	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.2
-0.300	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	-0.560

THE READ

Up front, the stuff-rate and sack numbers are close to even -- this one likely comes down to who wins on the perimeter instead of at the line of scrimmage. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Ohio -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Ohio 31.8-28.4 over Kent State (56% win probability), a projected margin of 3.3. On the ground, Kent State's rush offense (112.0 yds/g) lines up against Ohio's rush defense (225.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Kent State. Through the air, Ohio's pass offense (165.0 yds/g) faces Kent State's pass defense (304.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge Ohio. Heads up: Kent State does have the better Def Sacks/Game number in this game, which runs against the model's own pick above (in our logged games, the model hits 93.8% when Def Sacks/Game agrees with its pick, 87.1% when it doesn't) -- be aware.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Kent State's home-field rating (+12.0).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

BOWLING GREEN at MIAMI

Bowling Green (0-4) @ Miami (2-2)

Strength of Record -- Bowling Green: #135 | Miami: #80

Offensive identity -- Bowling Green: 41% pass / 59% run | Miami: 51% pass / 49% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.246	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.121
0.169	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.270

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
-1.650	F+	1.870
-0.860	FEI	1.140
2.7	Def Sacks/Game	2.7

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
6.7	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	43.3
0.2	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
-21.4	FPI (77% real win rate)	-7.7
-2.010	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	1.910
23.1	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	57.6
-0.640	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.650
29.0	QBR (73% real win rate)	96.9
-0.940	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	1.650
-0.1	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.4
0.2	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	-0.0
0.5	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.3
-0.5	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.5
3.4	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	7.3
0.1	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.7
-0.130	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.520

THE READ

Up front, Miami wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Miami -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Miami 47.2-3.5 over Bowling Green (96% win probability), a projected margin of 43.6. On the ground, Miami's rush offense (160.0 yds/g) lines up against Bowling Green's rush defense (263.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge Miami. Through the air, Miami's pass offense (339.7 yds/g) faces Bowling Green's pass defense (158.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge Miami.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Miami's home-field rating (+8.2).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

MARSHALL at JAMES MADISON

Marshall (3-1) @ James Madison (4-0)

Strength of Record -- Marshall: #54 | James Madison: #26

Offensive identity -- Marshall: 41% pass / 59% run | James Madison: 43% pass / 57% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.216	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.154
0.152	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.196

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
-0.840	F+	0.620
-0.490	FEI	0.300
0.7	Def Sacks/Game	4.0

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
19.3	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	30.7
0.2	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
-13.1	FPI (77% real win rate)	5.9
-0.450	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	0.340
32.4	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	34.1
-0.310	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.040
48.7	QBR (73% real win rate)	69.7
-1.180	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.860
0.1	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.3
0.3	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	-0.2
0.5	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.3
-0.2	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.3
4.9	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.4
0.4	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.5
-0.200	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.270

THE READ

Up front, James Madison wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors James Madison -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors James Madison 39.9-8.6 over Marshall (91% win probability), a projected margin of 31.3. On the ground, James Madison's rush offense (168.7 yds/g) lines up against Marshall's rush defense (152.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge James Madison. Through the air, James Madison's pass offense (202.3 yds/g) faces Marshall's pass defense (295.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge James Madison. James Madison also carries the turnover-margin edge (+0.7 vs -0.7).

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, $n=95$, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: James Madison's home-field rating (+8.7).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

MARYLAND at NEBRASKA

Maryland (2-2) @ Nebraska (4-0)

Strength of Record -- Maryland: #86 | Nebraska: #21

Offensive identity -- Maryland: 59% pass / 41% run | Nebraska: 44% pass / 56% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.234	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.152
0.227	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.182

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.090	F+	1.060
-0.080	FEI	0.530
2.3	Def Sacks/Game	3.3

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
22.3	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	45.3
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
-1.7	FPI (77% real win rate)	16.0
-0.060	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	1.100
37.2	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	55.6
-0.190	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.300
58.4	QBR (73% real win rate)	80.3
0.210	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.810
0.1	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.4
0.0	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	-0.0
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
-0.1	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.3
5.0	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	6.8
0.4	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.6
0.090	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.180

THE READ

Up front, Nebraska wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Nebraska -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Nebraska 38.2-19.6 over Maryland (80% win probability), a projected margin of 18.6. On the ground, Nebraska's rush offense (223.0 yds/g) lines up against Maryland's rush defense (154.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge Nebraska. Through the air, Nebraska's pass offense (256.3 yds/g) faces Maryland's pass defense (226.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge Nebraska. Nebraska also carries the turnover-margin edge (+1.7 vs -0.7).

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Nebraska's home-field rating (-8.0).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

UTEP at NEW MEXICO

UTEP (1-3) @ New Mexico (3-1)

Strength of Record -- UTEP: #116 | New Mexico: #63

Offensive identity -- UTEP: 34% pass / 66% run | New Mexico: 32% pass / 68% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.240	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.140
0.223	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.246

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
-1.770	F+	0.320
-1.130	FEI	0.020
0.7	Def Sacks/Game	2.3

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
8.0	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	28.7
0.2	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
-20.4	FPI (77% real win rate)	4.7
-1.520	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	0.000
18.4	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	38.5
-0.560	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.130
39.5	QBR (73% real win rate)	71.2
-1.560	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.470
-0.2	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.2
0.3	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	-0.1
0.5	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.3
-0.6	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.3
3.1	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	4.9
0.2	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.6
-0.410	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.060

THE READ

Up front, New Mexico wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors New Mexico -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors New Mexico 44.7-2.8 over UTEP (96% win probability), a projected margin of 41.9. On the ground, New Mexico's rush offense (175.7 yds/g) lines up against UTEP's rush defense (168.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge New Mexico. Through the air, New Mexico's pass offense (150.7 yds/g) faces UTEP's pass defense (259.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge New Mexico. New Mexico also carries the turnover-margin edge (+2.7 vs +0.3).

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, $n=95$, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: New Mexico's home-field rating (+7.6).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

KENTUCKY at SOUTH CAROLINA

Kentucky (3-1) @ South Carolina (2-2)

Strength of Record -- Kentucky: #11 | South Carolina: #88

Offensive identity -- Kentucky: 41% pass / 59% run | South Carolina: 47% pass / 53% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.156	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.130
0.168	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.243

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.650	F+	0.670
0.430	FEI	0.480
2.3	Def Sacks/Game	2.0

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
31.0	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	36.3
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
9.4	FPI (77% real win rate)	9.8
0.440	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	0.580
19.4	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	40.0
0.030	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.120
38.6	QBR (73% real win rate)	68.0
0.790	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.570
0.2	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.2
0.0	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.2
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
0.1	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.1
6.1	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	6.5
0.5	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.6
0.390	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.300

THE READ

Up front, South Carolina wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors South Carolina -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors South Carolina 36.7-26.4 over Kentucky (68% win probability), a projected margin of 10.3. On the ground, South Carolina's rush offense (214.3 yds/g) lines up against Kentucky's rush defense (143.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge South Carolina. Through the air, South Carolina's pass offense (284.0 yds/g) faces Kentucky's pass defense (230.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge South Carolina. Kentucky also carries the turnover-margin edge (-0.7 vs +1.0). **Caution: without South Carolina's +12.0-point home-field edge, the**

underlying stat blend alone actually favors Kentucky. Heads up: Kentucky does have the better Def Sacks/Game number in this game, which runs against the model's own pick above (in our logged games, the model hits 93.8% when Def Sacks/Game agrees with its pick, 87.1% when it doesn't) -- be aware.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: South Carolina's home-field rating (+12.0).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

PURDUE at ILLINOIS

Purdue (1-3) @ Illinois (2-2)

Strength of Record -- Purdue: #103 | Illinois: #76

Offensive identity -- Purdue: 53% pass / 47% run | Illinois: 50% pass / 50% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.159	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.114
0.151	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.207

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
-0.340	F+	0.660
-0.140	FEI	0.420
1.0	Def Sacks/Game	0.7

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
28.0	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	29.3
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
-3.1	FPI (77% real win rate)	6.8
0.350	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	1.250
42.9	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	43.8
0.100	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.440
82.1	QBR (73% real win rate)	89.5
-1.080	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	-0.170
0.2	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.3
0.4	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.2
0.5	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
-0.3	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	-0.0
5.3	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	6.4
0.5	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.6
-0.250	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	-0.080

THE READ

Up front, Illinois wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Illinois -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Illinois 39.3-28.5 over Purdue (69% win probability), a projected margin of 10.8. On the ground, Illinois's rush offense (153.3 yds/g) lines up against Purdue's rush defense (244.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Illinois. Through the air, Purdue's pass offense (310.7 yds/g) faces Illinois's pass defense (264.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Purdue. Illinois also carries the turnover-margin edge (+0.0 vs -1.0). Heads up: Purdue does have the better Def Sacks/Game number in this game, which runs against the model's own pick above

(in our logged games, the model hits 93.8% when Def Sacks/Game agrees with its pick, 87.1% when it doesn't) -- be aware.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, $n=95$, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Illinois's home-field rating (-2.5).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

OREGON STATE at COLORADO STATE

Oregon State (2-2) @ Colorado State (2-2)

Strength of Record -- Oregon State: #72 | Colorado State: #95

Offensive identity -- Oregon State: 67% pass / 33% run | Colorado State: 58% pass / 42% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.108	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.202
0.135	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.158

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
-0.070	F+	-0.660
-0.170	FEI	-0.510
4.0	Def Sacks/Game	1.0

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
25.7	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	34.3
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.2
-0.1	FPI (77% real win rate)	-6.6
-0.010	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	-0.080
31.6	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	43.5
-0.070	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.110
73.8	QBR (73% real win rate)	84.9
0.030	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	-1.190
0.3	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.3
0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.2
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.5
0.1	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	-0.2
6.4	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.7
0.4	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.4
-0.020	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	-0.390

THE READ

Up front, the stuff-rate and sack numbers are close to even -- this one likely comes down to who wins on the perimeter instead of at the line of scrimmage. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Colorado State -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Colorado State 31.9-29.5 over Oregon State (54% win probability), a projected margin of 2.4. On the ground, Oregon State's rush offense (77.0 yds/g) lines up against Colorado State's rush defense (238.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Oregon State. Through the air, Oregon State's pass offense (364.7 yds/g) faces Colorado State's pass defense (220.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Oregon State. **Caution: without Colorado State's +11.1-point home-field edge, the underlying stat blend alone actually favors Oregon State.**

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Colorado State's home-field rating (+11.1).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

BYU at TCU

BYU (3-0) @ TCU (2-2)

Strength of Record -- BYU: #25 | TCU: #94

Offensive identity -- BYU: 38% pass / 62% run | TCU: 49% pass / 51% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.122	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.164
0.224	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.211

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
1.220	F+	0.470
0.760	FEI	0.200
1.5	Def Sacks/Game	2.3

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
34.5	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	18.0
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
14.9	FPI (77% real win rate)	6.3
1.180	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	0.070
50.0	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	45.6
0.390	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.090
91.1	QBR (73% real win rate)	72.9
1.100	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.760
0.4	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.2
-0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	-0.1
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
0.4	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.0
8.0	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.1
0.6	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.3
0.360	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.220

THE READ

Up front, BYU wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors BYU -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors BYU 24.8-18.6 over TCU (61% win probability), a projected margin of 6.3. On the ground, BYU's rush offense (240.0 yds/g) lines up against TCU's rush defense (108.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge BYU. Through the air, TCU's pass offense (274.0 yds/g) faces BYU's pass defense (225.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge TCU. Heads up: TCU does have the better Def Sacks/Game number in this game, which runs against the model's own pick above (in our logged games, the model hits 93.8% when Def Sacks/Game agrees with its pick, 87.1% when

it doesn't) -- be aware.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: TCU's home-field rating (+12.0).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

ARKANSAS at TEXAS A&M; Arkansas (2-2) @ Texas A&M; (2-2)

Strength of Record -- Arkansas: #58 | Texas A&M;: #65

Offensive identity -- Arkansas: 58% pass / 42% run | Texas A&M;: 48% pass / 52% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.181	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.166
0.150	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.179

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.090	F+	0.850
0.110	FEI	0.640
2.0	Def Sacks/Game	1.0

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
20.3	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	31.3
0.2	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.2
2.2	FPI (77% real win rate)	15.1
0.360	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	0.660
42.2	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	39.7
0.110	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.170
63.9	QBR (73% real win rate)	48.1
-0.310	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.710
0.0	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.0
0.2	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.0
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
-0.1	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	-0.0
4.6	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	4.6
0.3	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.4
-0.050	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.310

THE READ

Up front, Texas A&M; wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Texas A&M; -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Texas A&M; 38.5-13.7 over Arkansas (86% win probability), a projected margin of 24.8. On the ground, Texas A&M;'s rush offense (151.5 yds/g) lines up against Arkansas's rush defense (153.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Texas A&M.; Through the air, Arkansas's pass offense (278.7 yds/g) faces Texas A&M;'s pass defense (212.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Arkansas. Heads up: Arkansas does have the better Def Sacks/Game number in this game, which runs against the model's own pick above (in our logged games, the model

hits 93.8% when Def Sacks/Game agrees with its pick, 87.1% when it doesn't) -- be aware.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, $n=95$, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Texas A&M's home-field rating (+12.0).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

UTSA at RICE

UTSA (3-1) @ Rice (1-3)

Strength of Record -- UTSA: #33 | Rice: #115

Offensive identity -- UTSA: 50% pass / 50% run | Rice: 28% pass / 72% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.172	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.132
0.124	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.184

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
-0.010	F+	-1.230
0.020	FEI	-0.860
0.7	Def Sacks/Game	0.7

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
32.0	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	15.0
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
-0.2	FPI (77% real win rate)	-14.0
0.400	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	-1.020
30.9	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	21.2
0.060	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.390
60.2	QBR (73% real win rate)	41.0
-0.380	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	-1.240
0.3	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.1
0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.1
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
-0.0	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	-0.3
5.5	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.3
0.5	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.3
0.010	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	-0.420

THE READ

Up front, Rice wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors UTSA -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors UTSA 36.6-23.4 over Rice (73% win probability), a projected margin of 13.2. On the ground, Rice's rush offense (205.7 yds/g) lines up against UTSA's rush defense (224.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge Rice. Through the air, UTSA's pass offense (210.3 yds/g) faces Rice's pass defense (228.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge UTSA. UTSA also carries the turnover-margin edge (-1.7 vs +1.0).

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Rice's home-field rating (+5.9).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

MIAMI at CLEMSON

Miami (4-0) @ Clemson (3-1)

Strength of Record -- Miami: #80 | Clemson: #24

Offensive identity -- Miami: 51% pass / 49% run | Clemson: 42% pass / 58% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.121	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.211
0.270	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.129

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
1.870	F+	0.330
1.140	FEI	0.170
2.7	Def Sacks/Game	2.0

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
43.3	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	21.0
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.2
-7.7	FPI (77% real win rate)	7.4
1.910	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	-0.530
57.6	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	27.3
0.650	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.280
96.9	QBR (73% real win rate)	34.1
1.650	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	1.080
0.4	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	-0.0
-0.0	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.0
0.3	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
0.5	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.0
7.3	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	4.7
0.7	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.4
0.520	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.380

THE READ

Up front, Miami wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Miami -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Miami 25.7-22.3 over Clemson (56% win probability), a projected margin of 3.3. On the ground, Miami's rush offense (160.0 yds/g) lines up against Clemson's rush defense (157.8 yds/g allowed) -- edge Miami. Through the air, Miami's pass offense (339.7 yds/g) faces Clemson's pass defense (214.8 yds/g allowed) -- edge Miami. Miami also carries the turnover-margin edge (-0.3 vs +0.7).

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, $n=95$, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Clemson's home-field rating (+5.8).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

TEXAS TECH at COLORADO

Texas Tech (4-0) @ Colorado (2-2)

Strength of Record -- Texas Tech: #9 | Colorado: #59

Offensive identity -- Texas Tech: 43% pass / 57% run | Colorado: 45% pass / 55% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.177	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.144
0.194	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.317

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
1.230	F+	-0.300
0.580	FEI	-0.240
2.3	Def Sacks/Game	1.7

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
37.3	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	11.3
0.2	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.2
17.0	FPI (77% real win rate)	-0.6
0.860	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	-0.670
50.0	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	31.8
0.020	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.320
75.2	QBR (73% real win rate)	58.6
1.400	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.260
0.3	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.1
0.0	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.0
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
0.0	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	-0.2
6.1	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	4.5
0.4	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.2
0.530	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.140

THE READ

Up front, the stuff-rate and sack numbers are close to even -- this one likely comes down to who wins on the perimeter instead of at the line of scrimmage. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Texas Tech -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Texas Tech 31.0-16.8 over Colorado (74% win probability), a projected margin of 14.3. On the ground, Texas Tech's rush offense (180.7 yds/g) lines up against Colorado's rush defense (116.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge Texas Tech. Through the air, Colorado's pass offense (190.7 yds/g) faces Texas Tech's pass defense (298.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge Colorado.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, $n=95$, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Colorado's home-field rating (+9.0).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

WASHINGTON at USC

Washington (3-1) @ USC (4-1)

Strength of Record -- Washington: #71 | USC: #29

Offensive identity -- Washington: 54% pass / 46% run | USC: 49% pass / 51% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.221	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.168
0.305	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.193

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.870	F+	1.350
0.510	FEI	0.860
2.3	Def Sacks/Game	1.6

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
21.3	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	39.8
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
4.4	FPI (77% real win rate)	14.8
0.500	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	2.270
28.2	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	56.1
0.130	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.800
67.0	QBR (73% real win rate)	90.4
1.160	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.050
0.2	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.3
-0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.2
0.3	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
0.1	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.2
5.1	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	6.8
0.4	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.7
0.380	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	-0.060

THE READ

Up front, the stuff-rate and sack numbers are close to even -- this one likely comes down to who wins on the perimeter instead of at the line of scrimmage. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors USC -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors USC 39.3-13.0 over Washington (88% win probability), a projected margin of 26.3. On the ground, USC's rush offense (164.4 yds/g) lines up against Washington's rush defense (100.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge USC. Through the air, USC's pass offense (325.0 yds/g) faces Washington's pass defense (180.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge USC. Washington also carries the turnover-margin edge (-0.2 vs +1.7). Heads up: Washington does have the better Def Sacks/Game number in this game, which runs against the model's own pick above (in our logged games, the model hits 93.8%

when Def Sacks/Game agrees with its pick, 87.1% when it doesn't) -- be aware.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: USC's home-field rating (+10.5).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sat, Oct 3

ARMY at LOUISIANA TECH

Army (2-1) @ Louisiana Tech (1-2)

Strength of Record -- Army: #78 | Louisiana Tech: #105

Offensive identity -- Army: 14% pass / 86% run | Louisiana Tech: 51% pass / 49% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.097	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.227
0.188	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.230

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
-0.070	F+	-0.680
-0.070	FEI	-0.410
0.5	Def Sacks/Game	4.0

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
22.5	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	16.5
0.0	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.2
-2.3	FPI (77% real win rate)	-6.7
0.070	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	-0.820
43.5	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	33.3
0.010	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.390
93.1	QBR (73% real win rate)	69.8
-0.280	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	-0.380
0.4	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.0
0.2	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	-0.0
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.3
-0.1	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	-0.3
5.3	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	3.5
0.4	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.2
-0.110	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.020

THE READ

Up front, the stuff-rate and sack numbers are close to even -- this one likely comes down to who wins on the perimeter instead of at the line of scrimmage. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Army -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Army 26.6-24.4 over Louisiana Tech (54% win probability), a projected margin of 2.2. On the ground, Army's rush offense (249.0 yds/g) lines up against Louisiana Tech's rush defense (156.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Army. Through the air, Louisiana Tech's pass offense (183.0 yds/g) faces Army's pass defense (240.5 yds/g allowed) -- edge Louisiana Tech. Louisiana Tech also carries the turnover-margin edge (+0.5 vs -0.5). Heads up: Louisiana Tech does have the better Def Sacks/Game number in this game, which runs against the model's own pick above (in our logged games,

the model hits 93.8% when Def Sacks/Game agrees with its pick, 87.1% when it doesn't) -- be aware.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Louisiana Tech's home-field rating (+12.0).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sun, Oct 4

INDIANA at RUTGERS

Indiana (4-0) @ Rutgers (1-3)

Strength of Record -- Indiana: #15 | Rutgers: #133

Offensive identity -- Indiana: 39% pass / 61% run | Rutgers: 51% pass / 49% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.118	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.161
0.236	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.200

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
1.930	F+	-0.300
1.160	FEI	-0.320
2.0	Def Sacks/Game	0.7

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
39.7	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	25.7
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
24.4	FPI (77% real win rate)	-3.7
1.800	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	0.330
47.1	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	38.2
0.540	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.040
92.7	QBR (73% real win rate)	67.5
1.710	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	-0.910
0.4	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.1
-0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.1
0.3	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
0.4	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	-0.3
7.3	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.7
0.7	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.3
0.550	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	-0.250

THE READ

Up front, Indiana wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Indiana -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Indiana 38.3-18.8 over Rutgers (81% win probability), a projected margin of 19.5. On the ground, Indiana's rush offense (212.7 yds/g) lines up against Rutgers's rush defense (178.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Indiana. Through the air, Rutgers's pass offense (280.3 yds/g) faces Indiana's pass defense (209.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge Rutgers. Indiana also carries the turnover-margin edge (-2.3 vs +0.7).

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, $n=95$, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Rutgers's home-field rating (+12.0).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sun, Oct 4

ARKANSAS STATE at LOUISIANA

Arkansas State (2-2) @ Louisiana (3-1)

Strength of Record -- Arkansas State: #99 | Louisiana: #57

Offensive identity -- Arkansas State: 49% pass / 51% run | Louisiana: 35% pass / 65% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.146	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.183
0.136	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.245

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
-0.870	F+	-0.420
-0.670	FEI	-0.410
0.7	Def Sacks/Game	1.3

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
16.0	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	28.3
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
-9.9	FPI (77% real win rate)	-3.0
-0.660	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	-0.550
41.7	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	32.5
-0.360	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.370
67.6	QBR (73% real win rate)	74.0
-1.000	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	-0.100
0.2	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.1
0.2	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	-0.2
0.5	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
-0.1	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.2
5.8	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	4.7
0.4	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.4
-0.320	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.040

THE READ

Up front, Louisiana wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Louisiana -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Arkansas State 24.4-23.9 over Louisiana (51% win probability), a projected margin of 0.5. On the ground, Louisiana's rush offense (168.0 yds/g) lines up against Arkansas State's rush defense (221.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Louisiana. Through the air, Arkansas State's pass offense (234.0 yds/g) faces Louisiana's pass defense (174.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge Arkansas State. Louisiana also carries the turnover-margin edge (+1.0 vs -0.3). **Caution: without Louisiana's -6.0-point home-field edge, the**

underlying stat blend alone actually favors Louisiana.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, R²=0.78, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Louisiana's home-field rating (-6.0).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sun, Oct 4

BAYLOR at ARIZONA STATE

Baylor (3-1) @ Arizona State (2-1)

Strength of Record -- Baylor: #50 | Arizona State: #41

Offensive identity -- Baylor: 49% pass / 51% run | Arizona State: 44% pass / 56% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.169	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.198
0.264	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.149

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.510	F+	0.290
0.250	FEI	0.210
3.7	Def Sacks/Game	1.5

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
25.0	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	22.0
0.2	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.2
7.7	FPI (77% real win rate)	3.0
0.300	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	-0.130
34.6	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	24.1
0.050	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.130
83.0	QBR (73% real win rate)	63.3
0.480	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.780
0.1	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.1
-0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.0
0.3	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
0.1	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	-0.1
4.8	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	4.5
0.4	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.3
0.080	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.370

THE READ

Up front, Baylor wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Baylor -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Arizona State 26.9-21.0 over Baylor (61% win probability), a projected margin of 5.9. On the ground, Baylor's rush offense (128.0 yds/g) lines up against Arizona State's rush defense (135.5 yds/g allowed) -- edge Baylor. Through the air, Baylor's pass offense (269.0 yds/g) faces Arizona State's pass defense (199.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Baylor. **Caution: without Arizona State's +12.0-point home-field edge, the underlying stat blend alone actually favors Baylor.**

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Arizona State's home-field rating (+12.0).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sun, Oct 4

TEXAS STATE at SAN DIEGO STATE

Texas State (2-2) @ San Diego State (1-3)

Strength of Record -- Texas State: #75 | San Diego State: #117

Offensive identity -- Texas State: 37% pass / 63% run | San Diego State: 44% pass / 56% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.139	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.203
0.250	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.111

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
-0.240	F+	-0.500
-0.240	FEI	-0.280
0.3	Def Sacks/Game	1.7

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
27.3	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	13.0
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.2
-2.0	FPI (77% real win rate)	-5.6
0.790	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	-1.020
56.1	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	27.9
0.150	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	-0.450
85.8	QBR (73% real win rate)	34.9
-1.170	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.050
0.3	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	-0.1
0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.1
0.5	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
-0.0	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	-0.3
6.4	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	4.3
0.5	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.2
-0.290	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.150

THE READ

Up front, Texas State wins the line of scrimmage on our stuff-rate and sack numbers above -- expect this one to be a smash-mouth, grind-it-out fight, yards coming in small chunks between the tackles. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Texas State -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Texas State 31.9-25.0 over San Diego State (62% win probability), a projected margin of 6.9. On the ground, Texas State's rush offense (262.3 yds/g) lines up against San Diego State's rush defense (198.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge Texas State. Through the air, San Diego State's pass offense (167.3 yds/g) faces Texas State's pass defense (370.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge San Diego State. Heads up: San Diego State does have the better Def Sacks/Game number in this game, which runs against the model's own pick

above (in our logged games, the model hits 93.8% when Def Sacks/Game agrees with its pick, 87.1% when it doesn't) -- be aware.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, $n=95$, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: San Diego State's home-field rating (+7.9).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sun, Oct 4

CINCINNATI at ARIZONA

Cincinnati (4-0) @ Arizona (3-1)

Strength of Record -- Cincinnati: #19 | Arizona: #51

Offensive identity -- Cincinnati: 38% pass / 62% run | Arizona: 52% pass / 48% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.132	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.118
0.179	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.253

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.610	F+	0.740
0.330	FEI	0.410
2.3	Def Sacks/Game	2.0

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
33.3	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	31.0
0.1	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.1
7.1	FPI (77% real win rate)	5.6
0.990	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	0.850
43.2	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	55.3
0.260	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	0.260
83.7	QBR (73% real win rate)	87.9
0.070	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	0.600
0.4	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.2
0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.0
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.4
0.1	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	0.2
6.3	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	5.8
0.5	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	0.6
0.040	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	0.190

THE READ

Up front, the stuff-rate and sack numbers are close to even -- this one likely comes down to who wins on the perimeter instead of at the line of scrimmage. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors Cincinnati -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Cincinnati 32.9-22.8 over Arizona (68% win probability), a projected margin of 10.1. On the ground, Cincinnati's rush offense (220.7 yds/g) lines up against Arizona's rush defense (109.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge Cincinnati. Through the air, Arizona's pass offense (294.7 yds/g) faces Cincinnati's pass defense (283.0 yds/g allowed) -- edge Arizona. Cincinnati also carries the turnover-margin edge (-0.3 vs +1.0). Heads up: Cincinnati does have the better Def Sacks/Game number in this game, which runs against the model's own pick above (in our logged games, the model

hits 93.8% when Def Sacks/Game agrees with its pick, 87.1% when it doesn't) -- be aware.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, $n=95$, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Arizona's home-field rating (-6.3).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.

THE SKINNY

Sun, Oct 4

SAN JOSE STATE at HAWAI'I

San Jose State (2-2) @ Hawai'i (1-3)

Strength of Record -- San Jose State: #97 | Hawai'i: #132

Offensive identity -- San Jose State: 55% pass / 45% run | Hawai'i: 64% pass / 36% run

TRENCHES SNAPSHOT

AWAY	STAT	HOME
0.186	Off Stuff Rate (suffered)	0.175
0.169	Def Stuff Rate (forced)	0.110

HEADLINE RATINGS (F+ / FEI / Def Sacks per Game -- always shown, green = real edge)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
-1.090	F+	--
-0.680	FEI	--
1.0	Def Sacks/Game	1.8

THE STATS THAT MATTER (top 15 real, highest win-rate first)

AWAY	STAT	HOME
21.0	Off Points/Game (78% real win rate)	18.0
0.2	Off Havoc Rate (suffered) (78% real win rate)	0.2
-13.2	FPI (77% real win rate)	-11.1
-1.310	Off F+ (77% real win rate)	--
36.4	Off 3rd Down % (77% real win rate)	39.7
-0.500	Off FEI (76% real win rate)	--
50.3	QBR (73% real win rate)	57.5
-0.610	Def F+ (73% real win rate)	--
0.1	Off PPA (73% real win rate)	0.0
0.1	Def PPA Allowed (73% real win rate)	0.2
0.4	Def Success Rate Allowed (CFBD) (72% real win rate)	0.5
-0.2	Net Success Rate (71% real win rate)	--
5.4	Off Yards/Play (71% real win rate)	4.5
0.2	Off Success Rate (bcftoys) (71% real win rate)	--
-0.120	Def FEI (71% real win rate)	--

THE READ

Up front, the stuff-rate and sack numbers are close to even -- this one likely comes down to who wins on the perimeter instead of at the line of scrimmage. The clearest real edge on the sheet is Off Points/Game, which favors San Jose State -- in our own 94 logged games, the team with the better Off Points/Game has won 78% of the time. Projection favors Hawai'i 26.4-21.0 over San Jose State (60% win probability), a projected margin of 5.4. On the ground, San Jose State's rush offense (110.0 yds/g) lines up against Hawai'i's rush defense (178.3 yds/g allowed) -- edge San Jose State. Through the air, Hawai'i's pass offense (258.5 yds/g) faces San Jose State's pass defense (233.7 yds/g allowed) -- edge Hawai'i. Hawai'i also carries the turnover-margin edge (+0.0 vs -1.3). **Caution: without Hawai'i's +8.6-point home-field edge, the underlying stat blend alone actually favors San Jose State.** Heads up: Hawai'i

does have the better Def Sacks/Game number in this game, which runs against the model's own pick above (in our logged games, the model hits 93.8% when Def Sacks/Game agrees with its pick, 87.1% when it doesn't) -- be aware.

Real backtested margin model: FPI +0.30/pt, Efficiency +0.59/pt, Scoring +0.61/pt, Yardage +0.45/pt, Turnovers -0.11/pt (real OLS fit, n=95, $R^2=0.78$, MAE=7.9 pts, in-sample). Home-field: Hawai'i's home-field rating (+8.6).

Bold box = real edge on that stat this matchup. Green fill = real edge on a headline stat (F+/FEI/Def Sacks/Game, or the next 2 highest real win-rate stats). Yellow highlight in THE READ below = F+ and FEI both favor the team OPPOSITE the model's own pick. Win rates based on 47-95 logged games per stat, recomputed fresh this run from cfb_stat_history.json -- see cfb_matrices_outlook.pdf for the full stat sheet.